are influenced by the position of the land, sea and mountains. The strategic position of mountains, valleys, rivers and plains and deserts not only helps in communication but also in matters of security like the Himalayas, the Alps which are like natural barriers.

Natural resources of a state improve its bargaining capacity, internationally. Huge possession of resources does not add up to one's strength but the utilization of the particular product does. Thus, huge quantities of oil have helped the West Asian and Gulf countries to embark on the policy of oil diplomacy. The most noteworthy incident that shook the international economy was the oil embargo by the OPEC countries in 1973. Self-sufficiency in food, mineral and energy resources has also helped the United States and Russian foreign policy choices.

2. ***History and Culture:*** The political tradition of a state has its roots in its history and culture. The historical and cultural traditions provide the basic guidelines for formulating the basic foreign policy objectives. The bitter experiences of colonialism, imperialism and racialism have strengthened the resolve of many countries for developing anti-imperialist, anti-colonial and anti-racist stance. Gandhi's idea of *ahimsa* (non-violence) and India's policy of *peaceful coexistence*, as reflected in the ***panchsheel***, also have roots in the history and culture of the country.

3*. Economic Development:* The economic performance of a state in terms of GNP provides the key to understanding the state's ability to utilize its natural and human resources which, in turn, influences its foreign policy choices and menu. The United States, by far the largest economy recording the highest GNP, is always able to secure its foreign policy objectives vis-à-vis underdeveloped and developing states, and to some extent in relation to certain developed states too, such as Britain and France. The levels of high economic development provide leverage to the countries to flex their muscles in their relations with economically weak countries. The developing world, to a great extent, is dependent on the developed world for capital, technology and military research and development and supply of armaments. This places them in a disadvantageous position and they have serious impediments in pursuing an